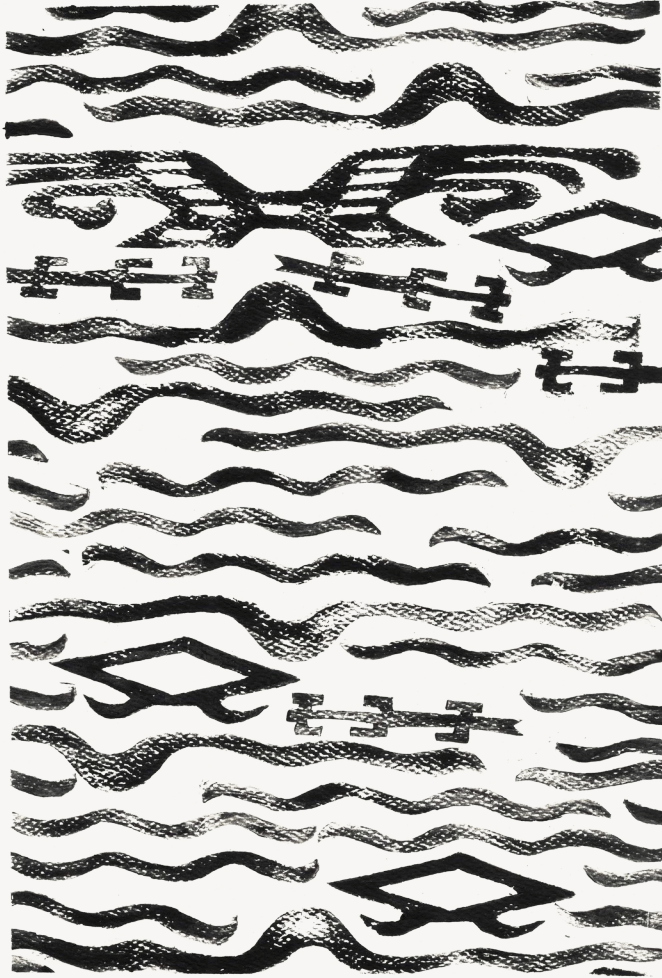


portfolio



Narita Reyes Ico
MArch, MLA, BEnDs
Selected works
06.2020 - 04.2026

about the designer

Narita is a Filipina designer currently living and learning as a guest on the unceded and ancestral land of the xʷməθkʷəy̓əm (Musqueam) people where she is a recent graduate of the Master of Architecture and Landscape Architecture Dual Degree program at the University of British Columbia. She is the recipient of the 2021 IOC IPC IAKS Bronze Medal Architecture & Design Award for Young Professionals. She has featured works in the 2023 Venice Biennale under the Architects Against Housing Alienation collective. She has completed fellowships with Canada’s Pavilion at the Venice Biennale (Italy) in 2025 and the Banff Arts Centre (Alberta, Canada) in 2026.

Her work is grounded in cultural knowledge and she believes that handcrafts tied with technical skills can extend further to communities to design for the land, waters, and people supported by these systems.

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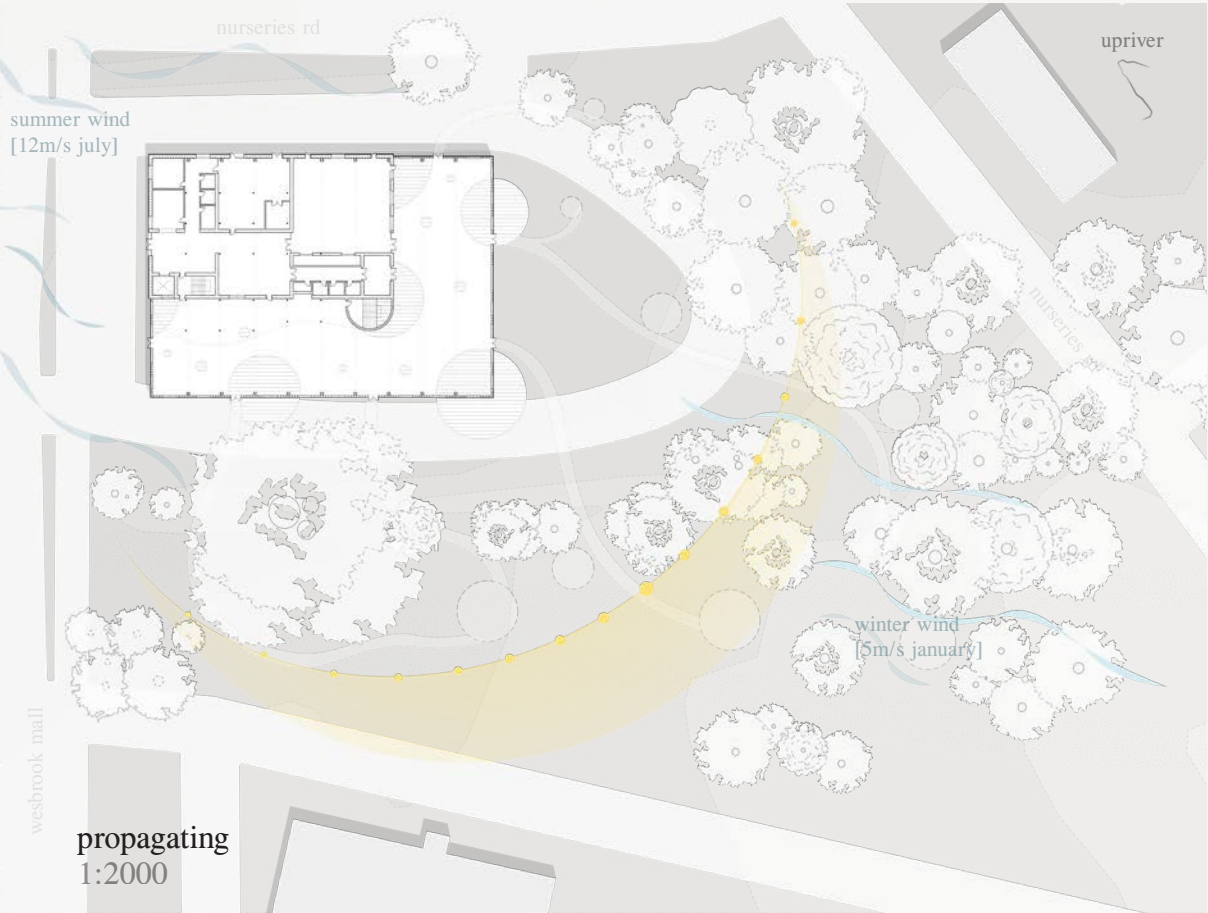
seed to table robyn adams & narita reyes ico comprehensive studio fall 2025	04
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seed to table

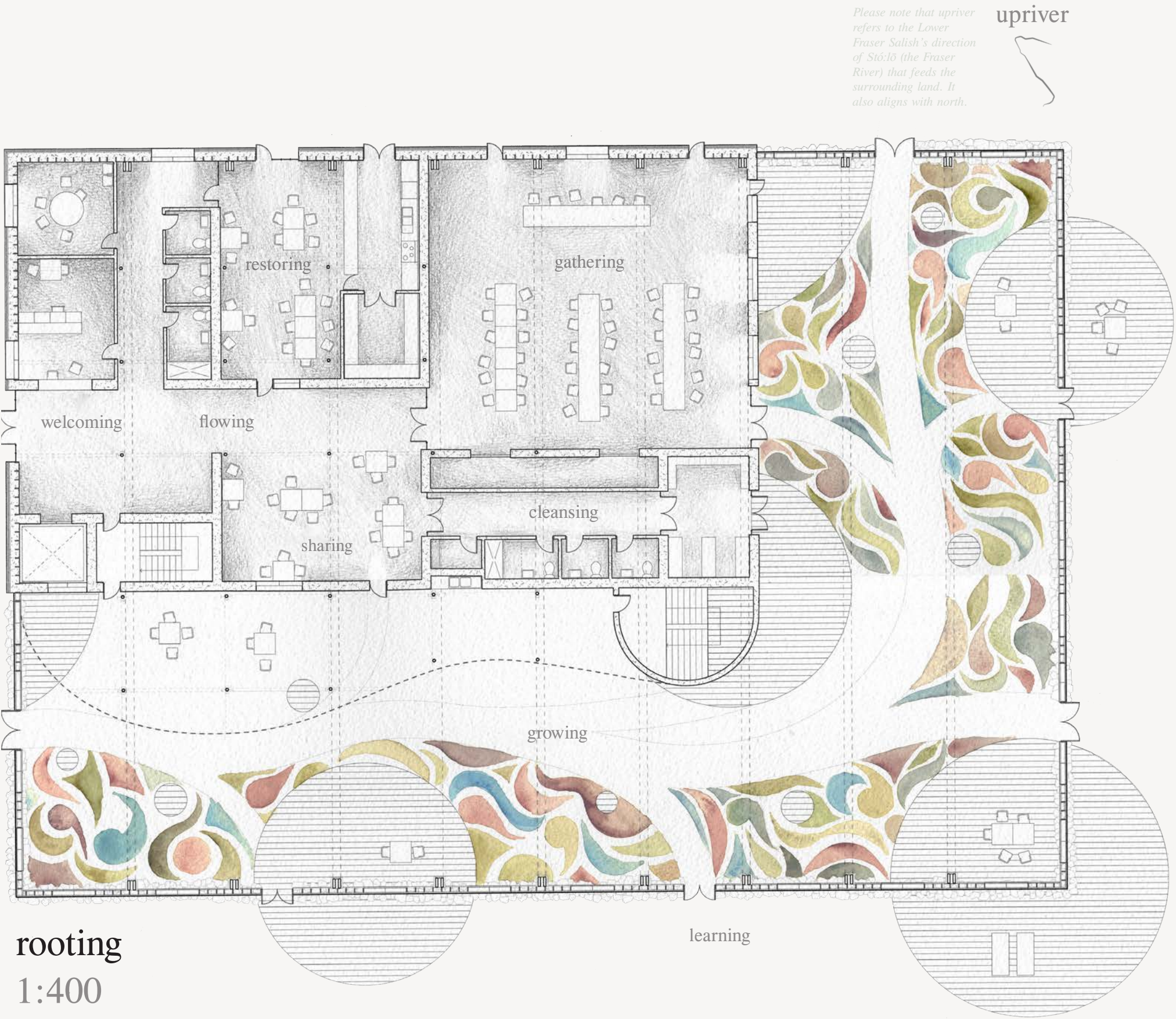
Location: UBC, Vancouver, BC
Course: Comprehensive Design Studio
Date: 01.2024 - 04.2024
Professor: Joanne Gates
Collaborator: Robyn Adams

Seed to table adaptively reuses UBC’s Opera Warehouse into a greenhouse research facility focused on food security. Located between UBC Farm and Pacific Spirit Park, this building aims to foster community, connect the local environment, and nurture practices of growing, research and learning.

This project will be featured in an upcoming issue of Site Magazine, to be released in May 2026.

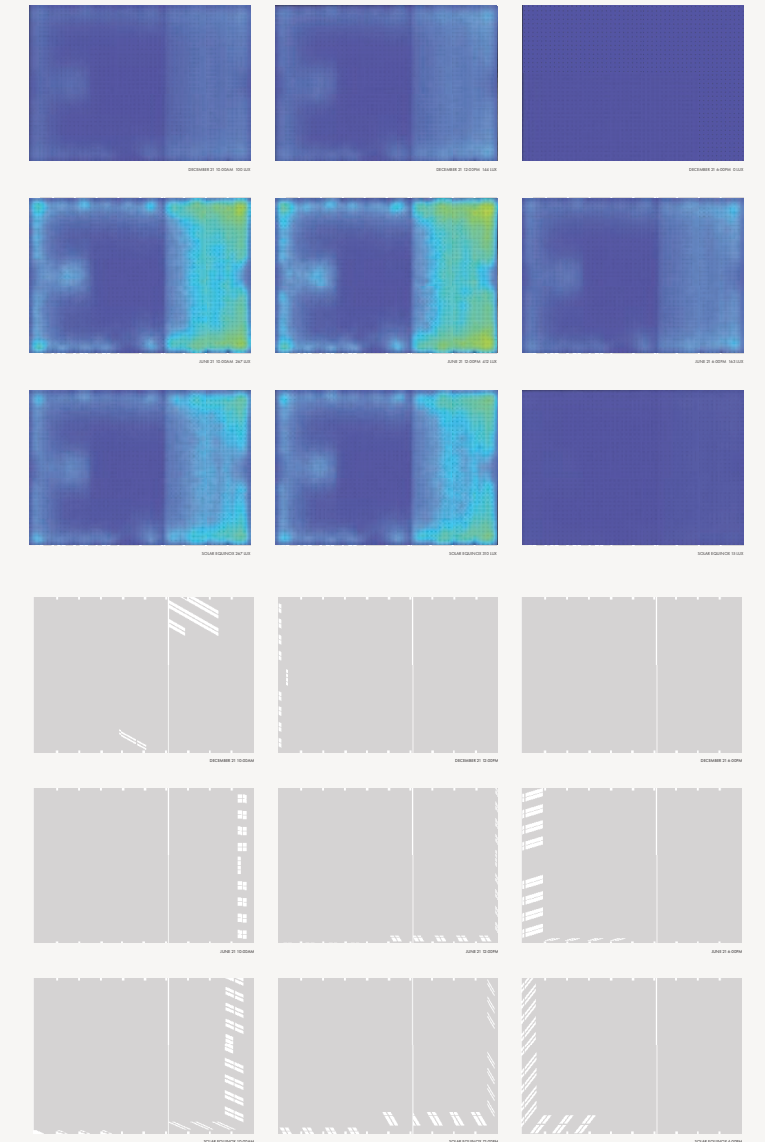


Handmade planting plan on hide.
Beading by Robyn Adams & embroidered
contour lines by Narita Reyes Ico



building analysis

Through simulations in Climate Studio, we were able to understand lighting and climate conditions within the existing building. This particularly supported the way in which we laid out and planned for the community gardening areas as seen in the watercoloured areas on the ground plan (left).



Plan by Narita Reyes Ico
Climate simulations by Robyn Adams

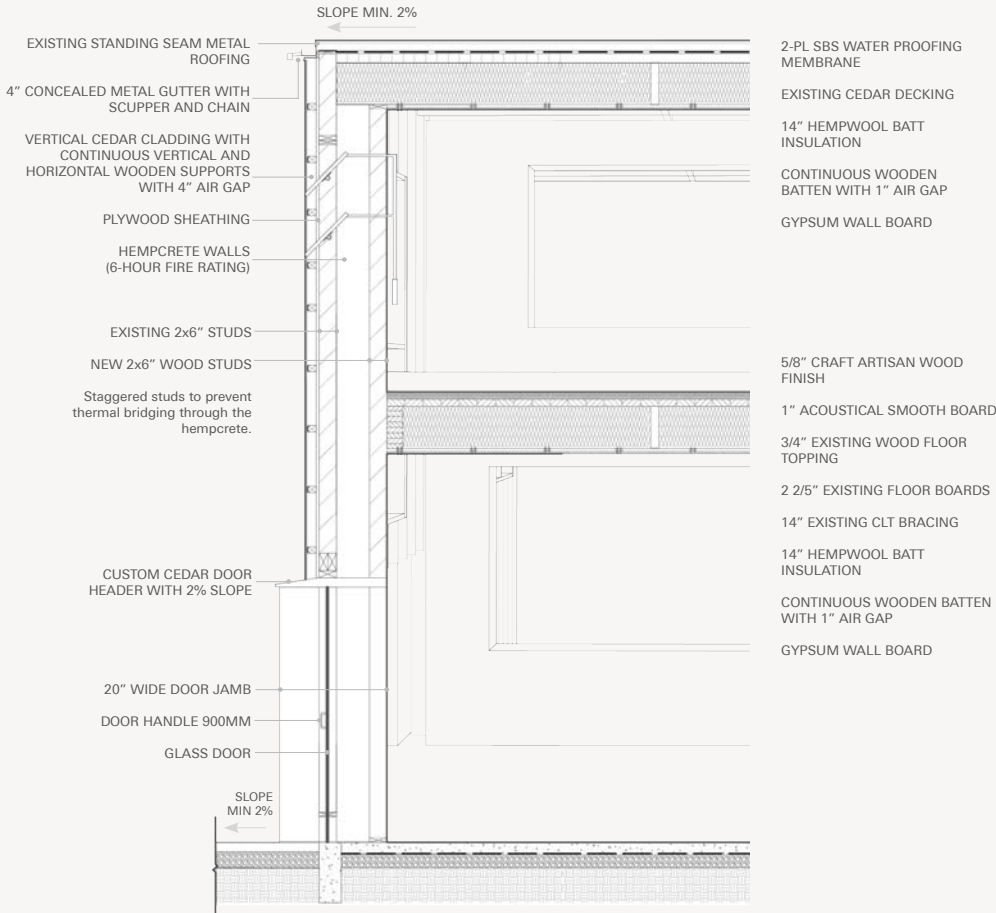


Section by Narita Reyes Ico

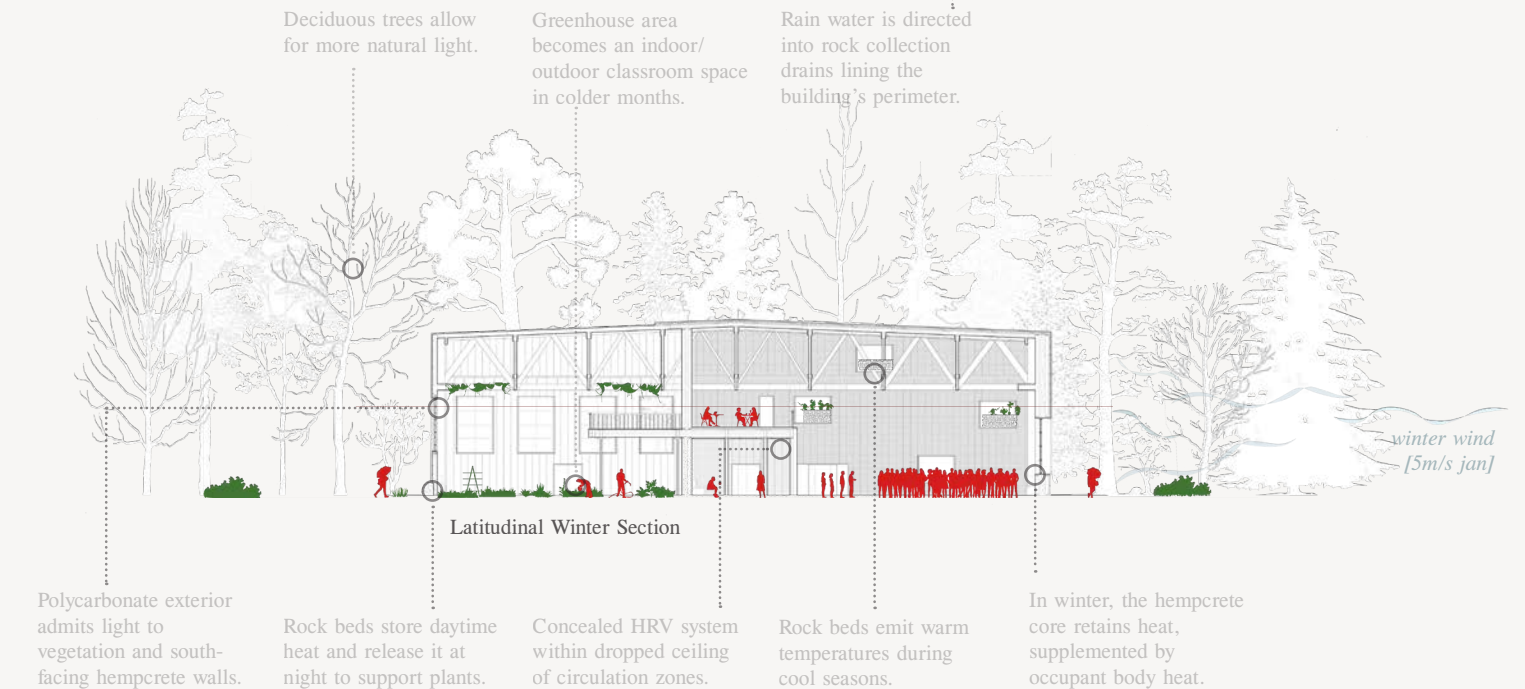
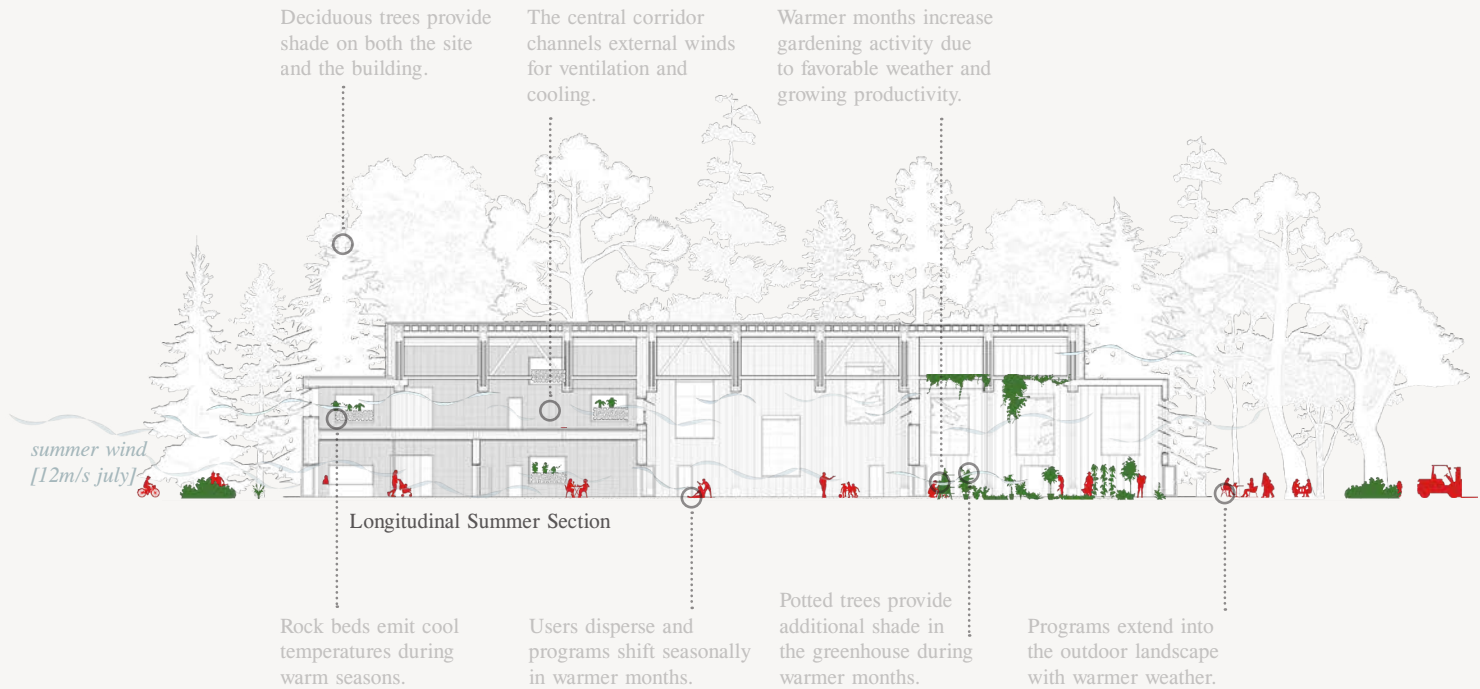
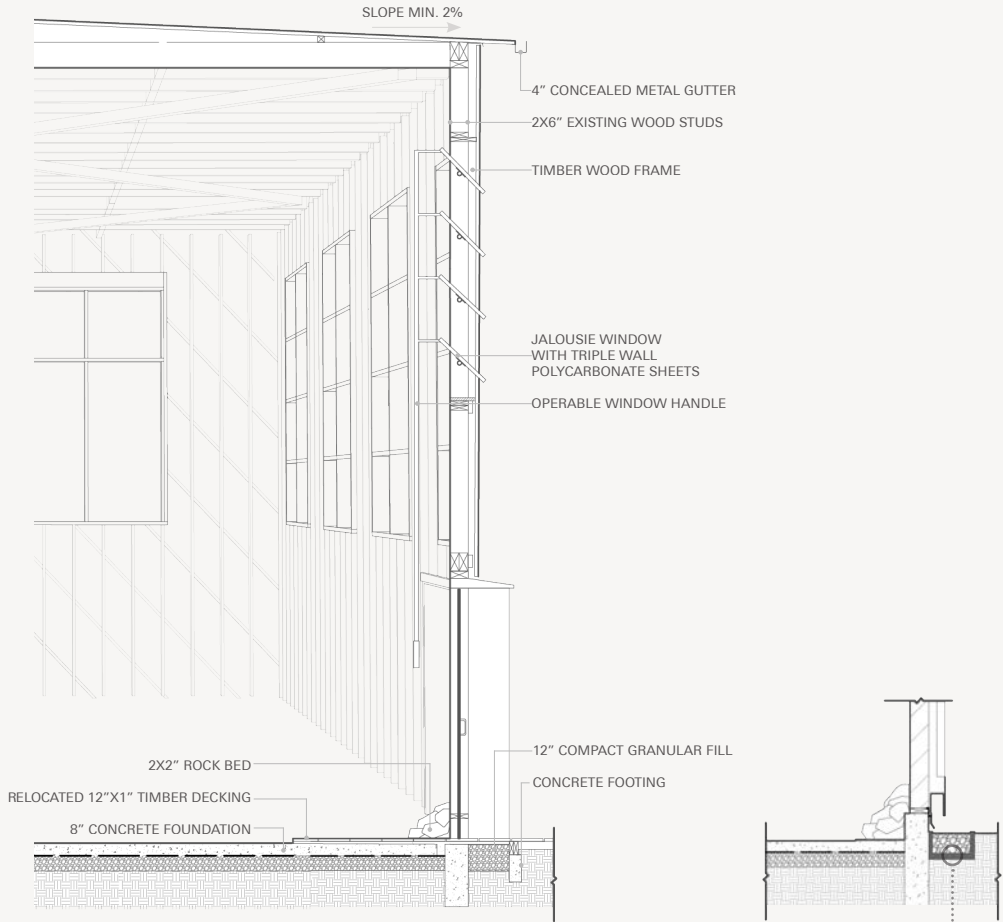
harvesting
1:250

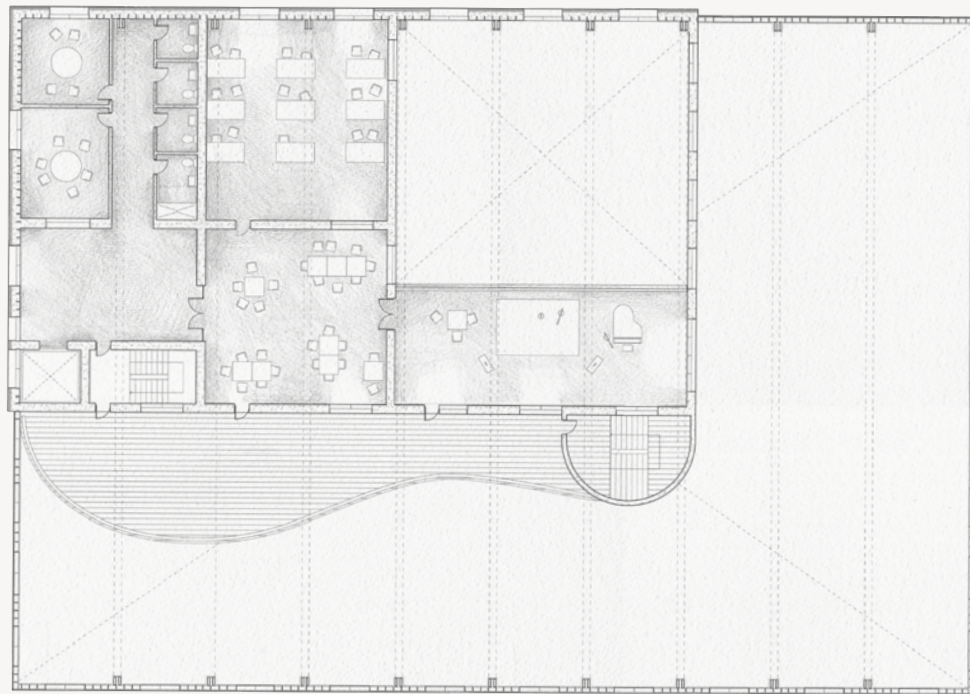
Detail Sections
1:100

Detailed sections and
diagram sections by
Narita Reyes Ico



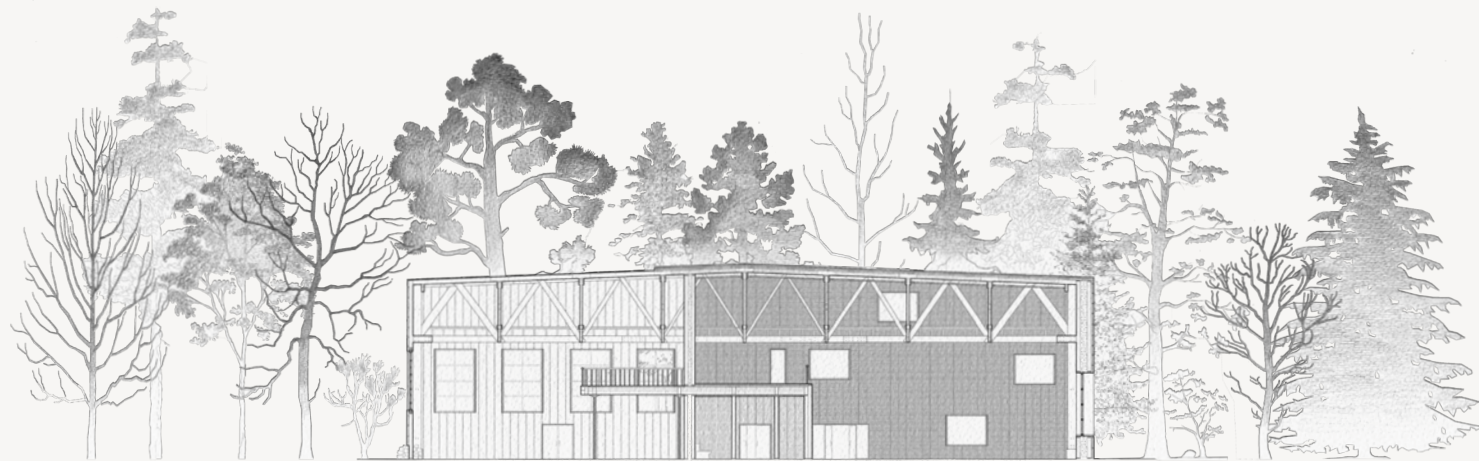
Greenhouse
Facade Section



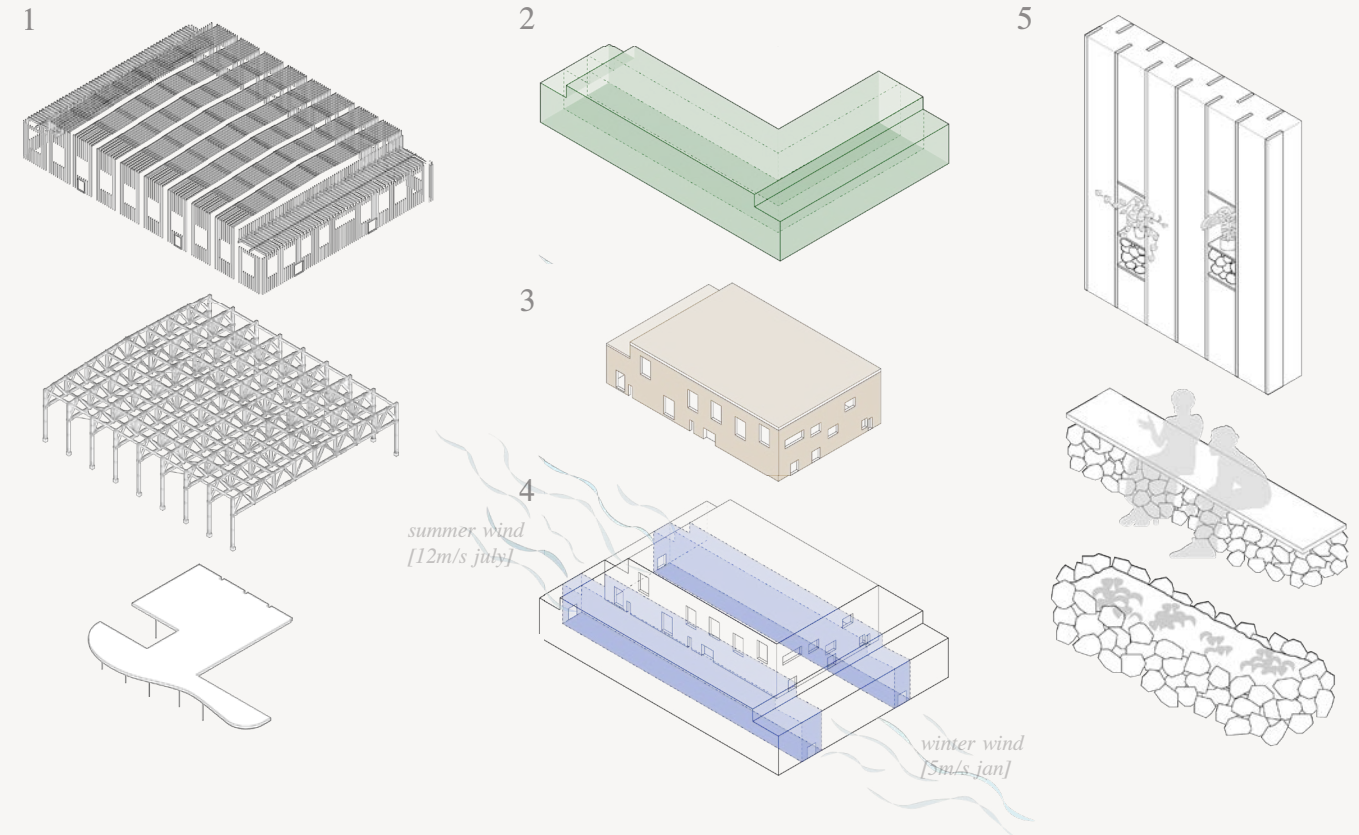


Plan and section by
Narita Reyes Ico

sprouting
1:750



nurturing
1:750



main design elements

Diagrams by
Narita Reyes Ico

1. Reuse of Existing Structure

The existing studs, joists, columns, beams, mezzanine, and roof are reused.

2. Greenhouse as Thermal Gradient

The rocks and hempcrete slowly emit the heat built throughout the day into the greenhouse at night.

3. Hempcrete Core

Hempcrete is used as insulation and thermal mass. It is a well ventilated material, with a good fire rating, and is carbon negative.

4. Double-loaded Arrangement

The central corridors align with the direction of incoming summer and winter winds to encourage ventilation.

5. Rock Beds

Rock beds provide thermal comfort and regulation to their surroundings.



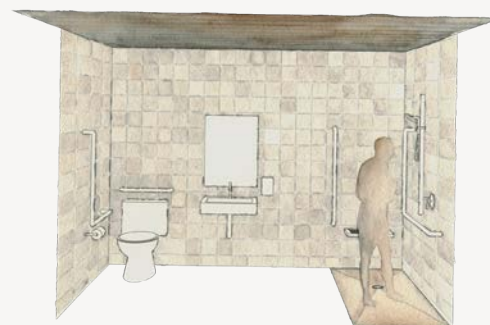
seed



restoring



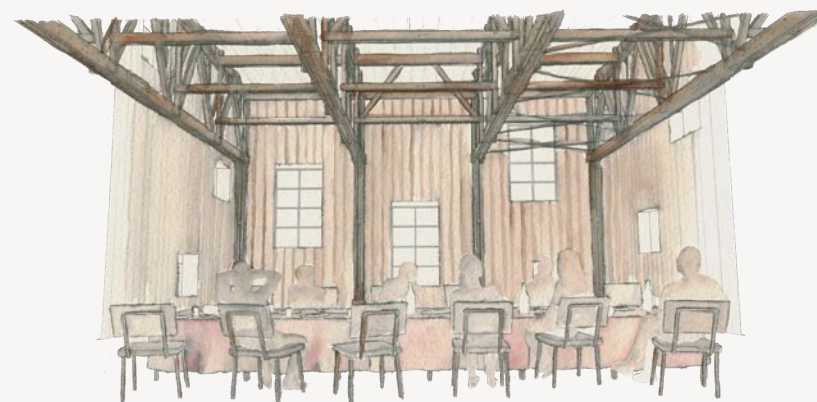
learning



cleansing

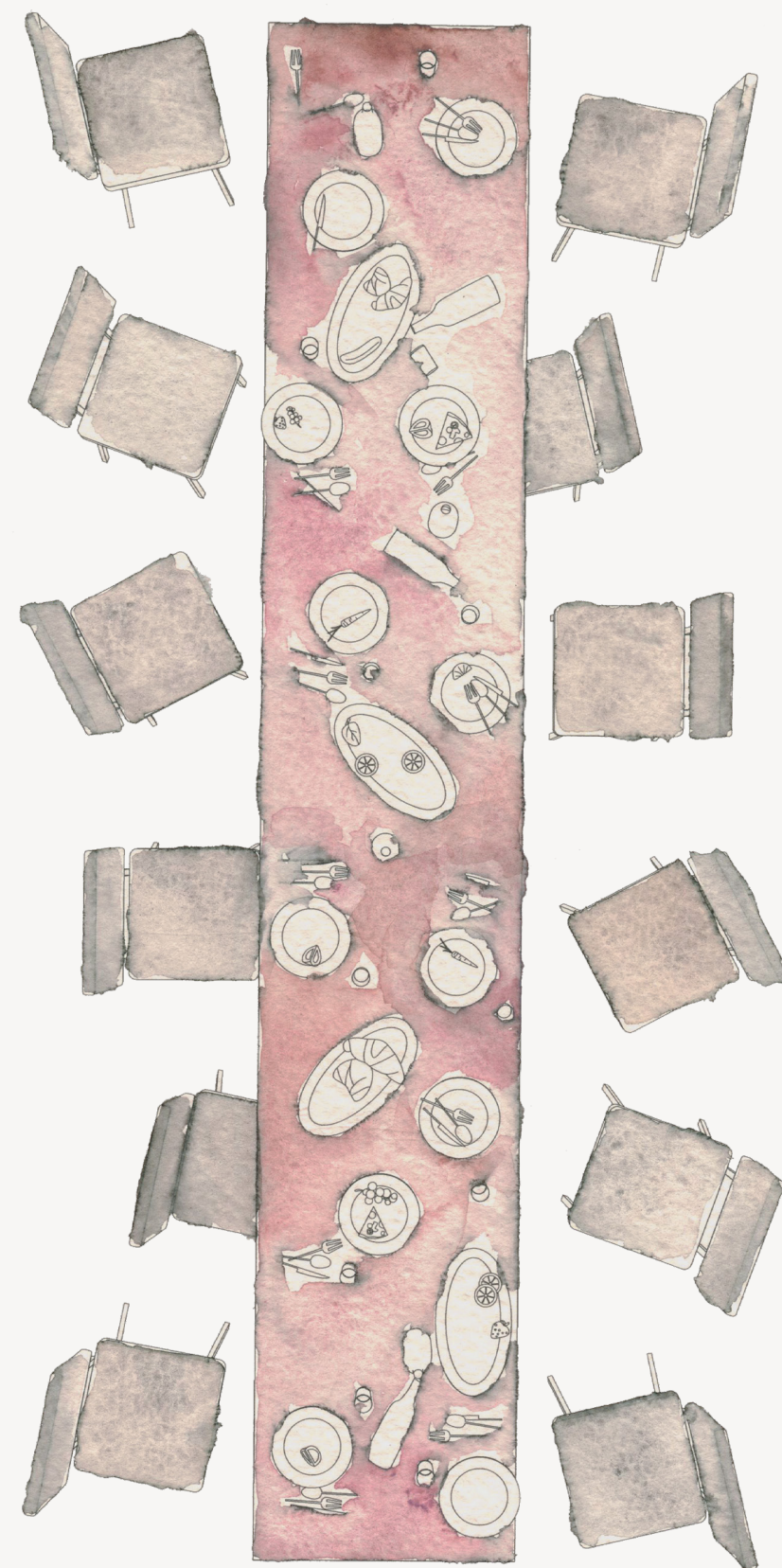


growing



gathering

Watercolour renders
by Narita Reyes Ico



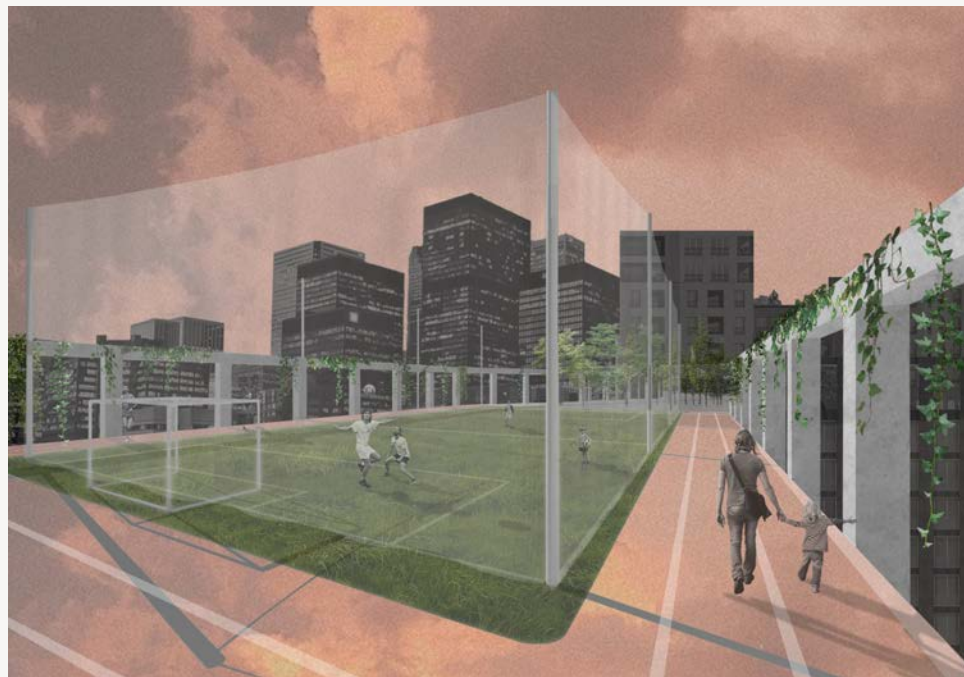
to table

the granville gateway

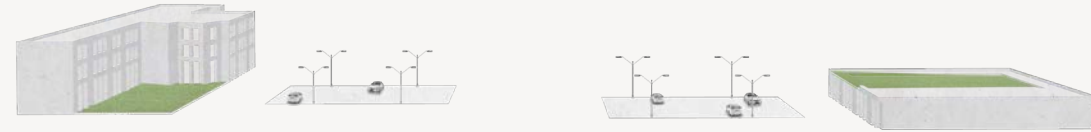
Location: Vancouver, BC
 Year: 01.2021 - 04.2021
 Award: IOC IPC IAKS Bronze Medal
 Architecture & Design Award for
 Young Professionals 2021



The Granville Gateway is an entrance into one of the most iconic areas of Vancouver, the Entertainment District. It transforms two underutilized parking lots and their adjacent green spaces into a cohesive community and recreation centre. Through the rehabilitation and revitalization of disused spaces, future urban environments can foster a balanced relationship between nature and the city. The floating forest hovers above the street and is an elevated escape from the hustle of the City. The Granville Gateway is not only a recreation centre, but a congregational space for social and community interaction.



Building form



Current Lots



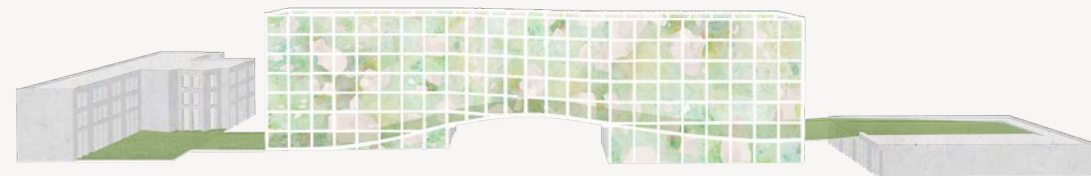
Traversing Green Space



West & East of Centre



West & East Connection

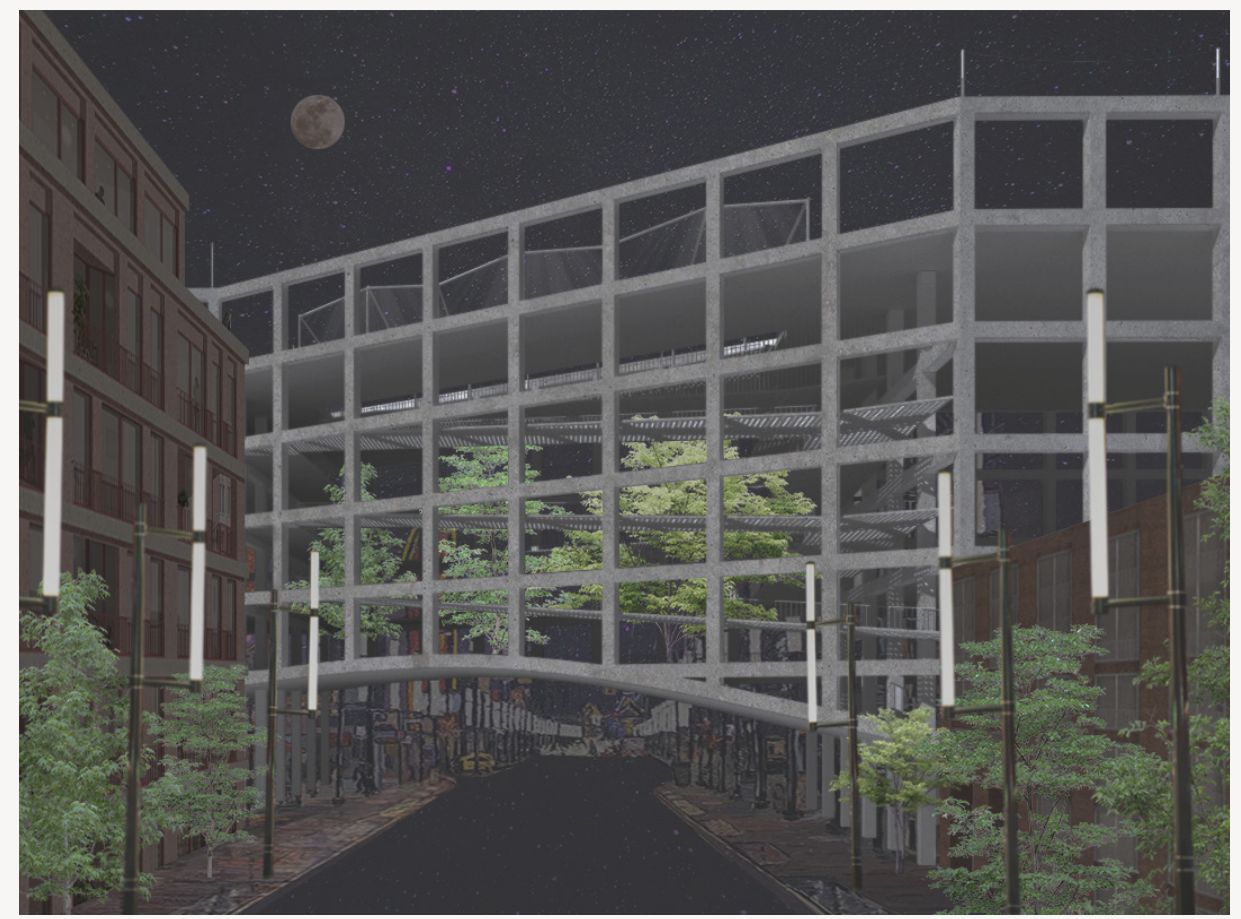
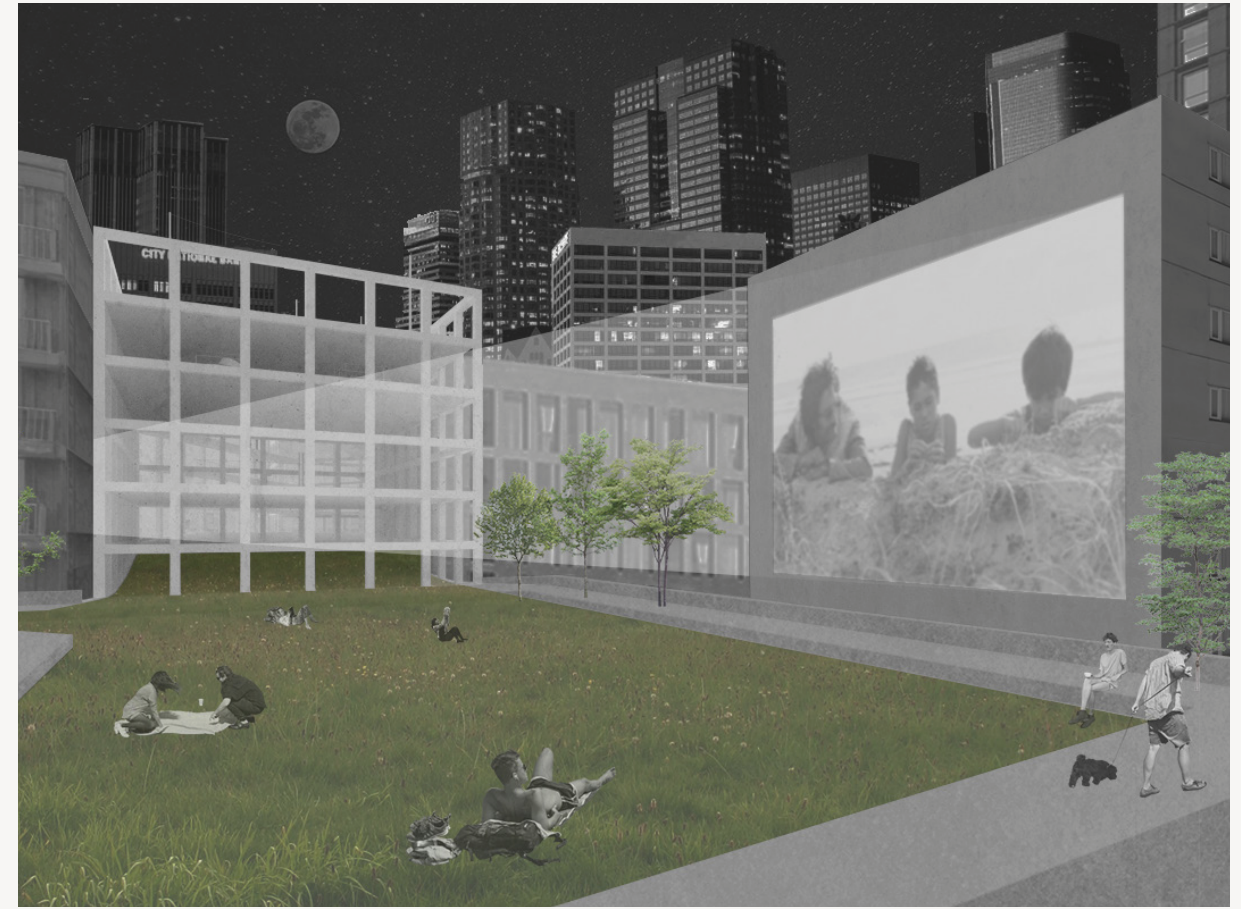


Structural Framework





- | | | | |
|-----------------|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| 1. Parking | 5. Reception | 9. SW Park | 13. Sports Field |
| 2. NE Park | 6. Granville Street | 10. Tennis Court | 14. Rooftop Lounge |
| 3. Playground | 7. Public Plaza | 11. Gymnasium | 15. Sports Court |
| 4. Bike Storage | 8. Indoor Atrium | 12. Fitness Centre | 16. Running Track |





- | | | | |
|------------------|---------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| 1. NE Park | 5. Universal Stalls | 9. Rooftop Lounge | 13. Fitness Centre |
| 2. Running Track | 6. Playground | 10. Indoor Atrium | 14. Gymnasium |
| 3. Sports Field | 7. Parking | 11. Granville Street | 15. Public Plaza |
| 4. Tennis Courts | 8. Reception | 12. Sports Court | 16. SW Park |

provisional structures

Location: Regina, SK
Year: 06. 2020 - 08. 2020
Firm: Goodweather
Collaborator: Michael Lis
Artist: Carmen Papalia

Michael Lis (Goodweather Director) and I collaborated with Vancouver-based artist, Carmen Papalia. The Provisional Structure draws on his experience as a non-visual learner, a term he chooses to identify with over the medicalizing terminology of “blind” or “visually impaired.” I was responsible for translating the real-world idea into a hand-scaled model that communicated the concept and physical structure to Carmen. This was an iterative process that involved leaning into senses beyond sight such as sound, hearing, smell, and touch.

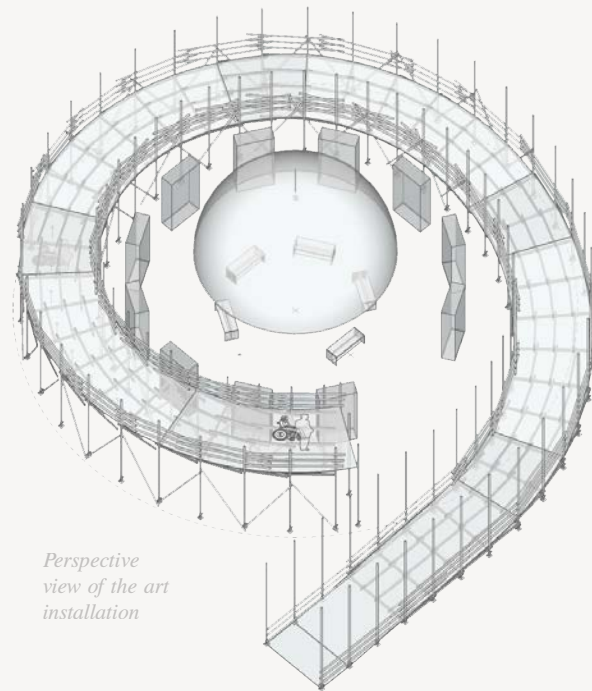
The exhibition was on display at the MacKenzie Art Gallery in Regina, Saskatchewan from June 12th to October 17th of 2021.



Photo by Don Hall, Photographer

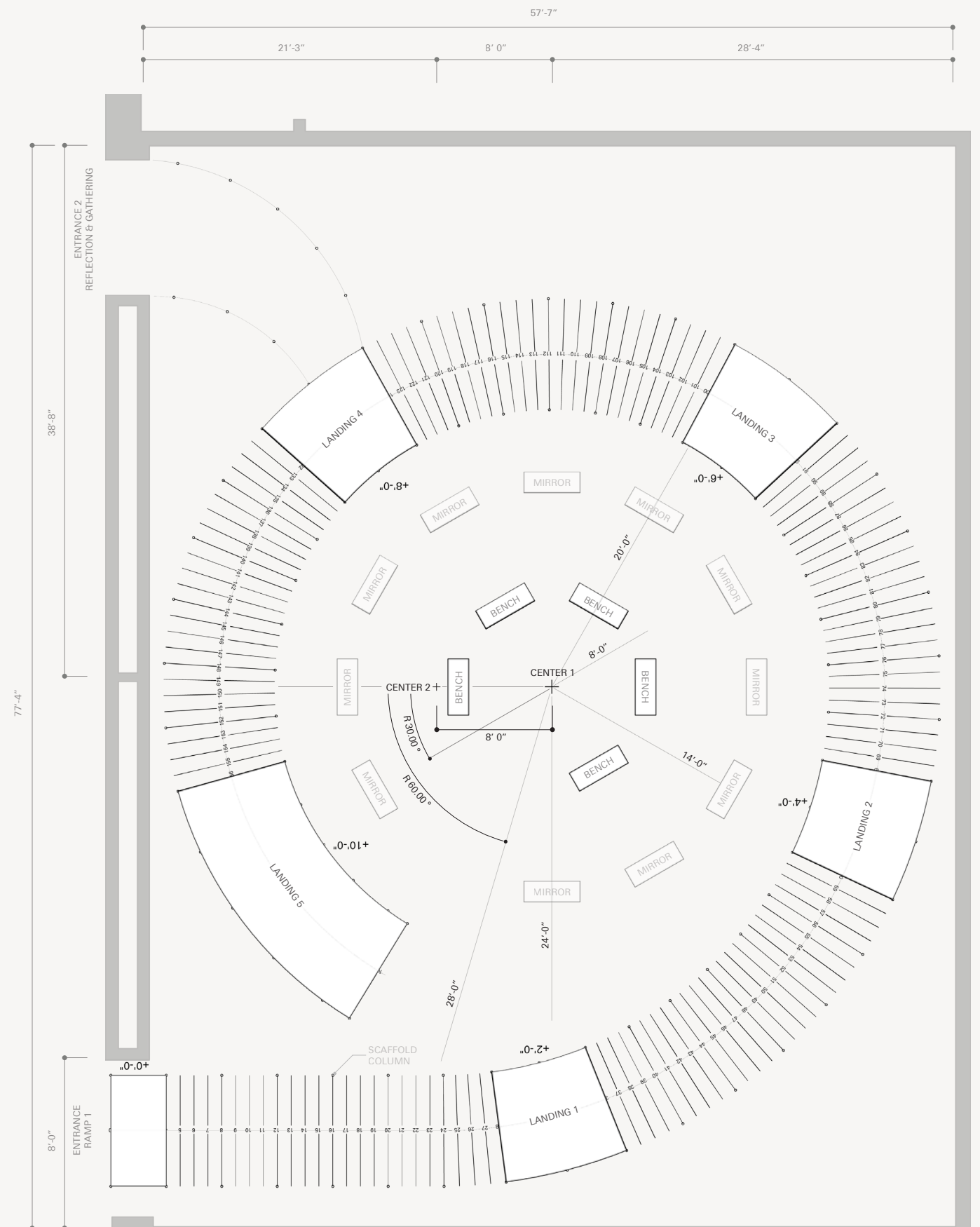
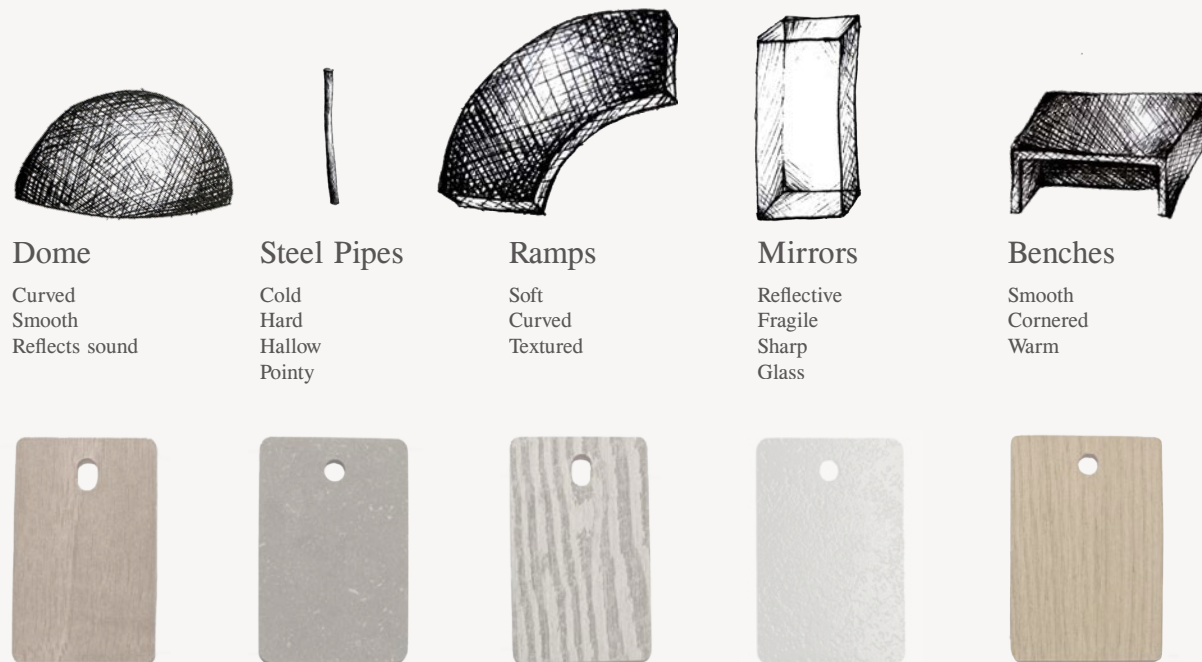


*Photo by Michael Lis
Model by Narita Reyes Ico*



Sketches and material swatches by Narita Reyes Ico.

Floor plan by Michael Lis and Narita Reyes Ico



Model Materiality

Dome

Stacked ringed 3mm Russian Birch Plywood lined with plush fabric.

Benches

Made of 3mm Russian Birch Plywood. Edges sanded down.

Mirrors

Made of stacked 3 mm acrylic. Spray painted mirror finish.

Ramp

Made of 3mm plywood. Graining on wood.

Steel Piping

For steel scaffolding use piano wire. Sand all edges of ramp and piano wire points.

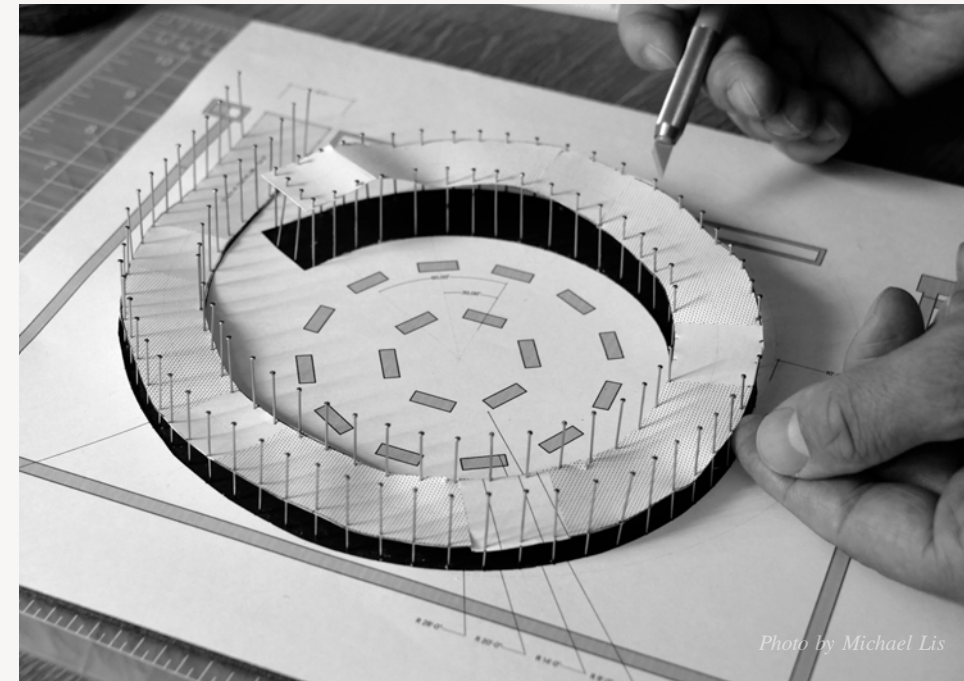
Walls

Made of a combination of 3mm and 6mm White painted Russian Birch Plywood.

Base

Made of 6mm White Painted Russian Birch Plywood base. Puzzle fit base to fit pieces in.

Overall dimensions:
22" x 20" x 6"



Concept parti model
by Michael Lis. (left)

Non-visual artist, Carmen Papalia, understanding the gallery installation's physical structure solely through touch. Model by Narita Reyes Ico. (below)



Photo by Michael Lis

saling-tubig

Course: Graduate Project
Chair: Tania Gutierrez-monroy
Committee: Robyn Adams,
Antoinette Baquiran, & Michelle Bullough
Award: Will Marsh - Doug Paterson Scholarship

Saling-tubig tells the story of my grandparents who spent over a year drifting on a bangka in the West Philippine Sea to seek refuge from the Japanese Imperial Army during World War II. Through their story of survival, this project explores the bangka, the traditional dugout canoe of the Philippines, as an integral piece of Filipino architecture that has shaped my family’s understanding of water, land, and the Filipino spirit. By writing, drawing, and binding their experience, my family’s stories continue to be woven into the hands of the generations to follow.



Photo by Robyn Adams

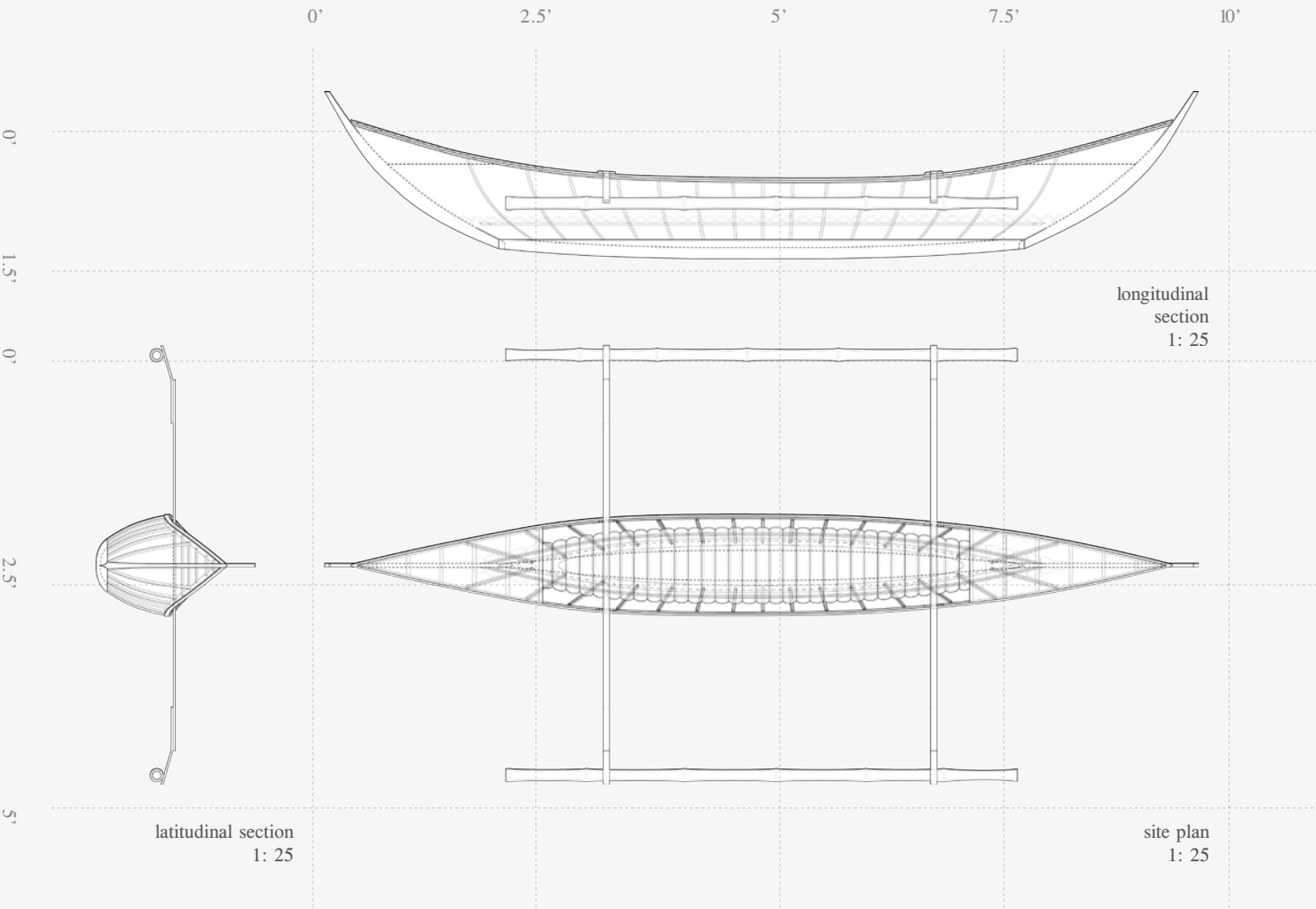
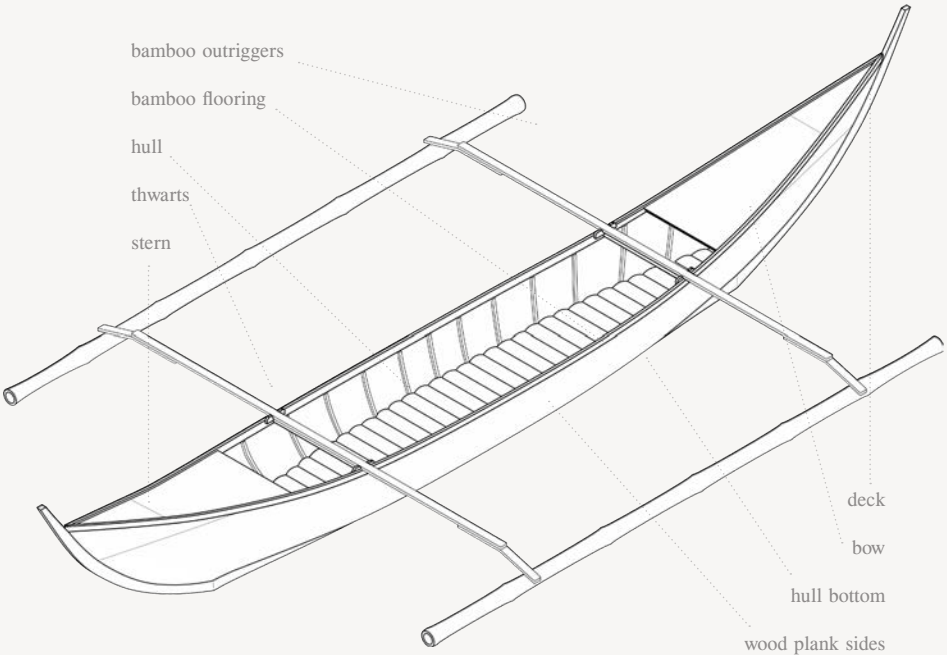
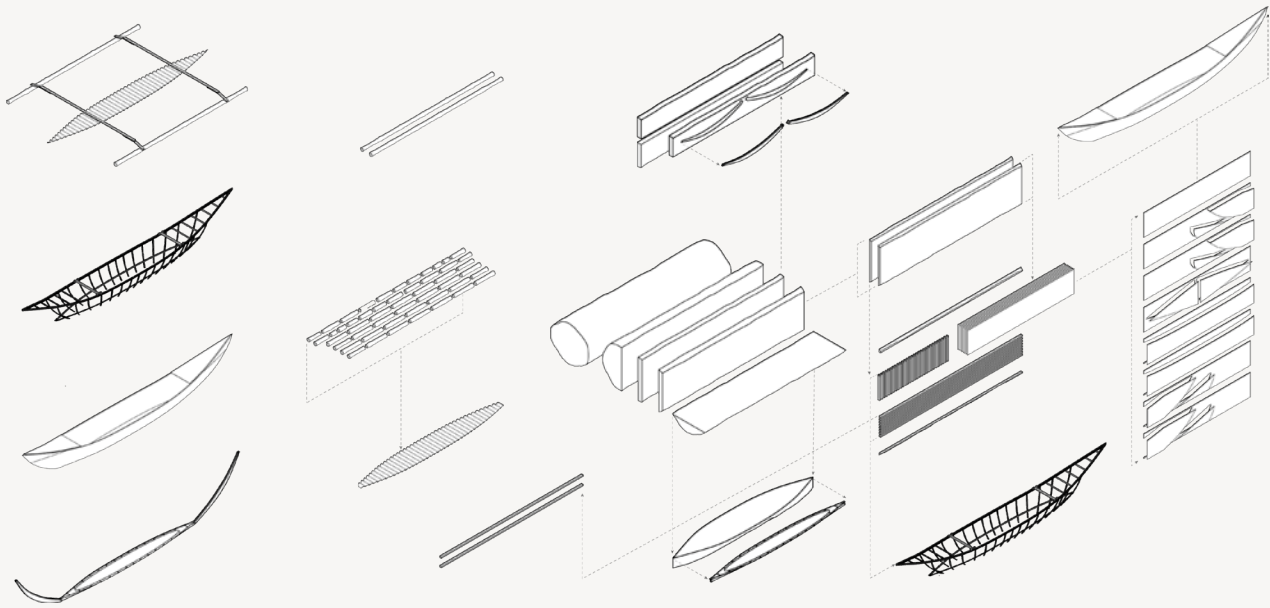
Photo by
Narita Reyes Ico



the bangka construction and its environment

The traditional Philippine dugout canoe is carved from the trunk of one tree and is transformed into different elements of the bangka. It can have many variations depending on regions, passed down carving traditions, or other desires of the artisan. Its long, skinny, and simple form is supported by two katig’s (English Translation: bamboo outriggers) which ensures stability and strength on rough seas.

The bangka cannot be understood as an isolated object; rather, it is a result of its environment, encompassing water, land, air, and the human communities that sustain and give it meaning.



philippine cycle teachings

stars as navigators

Planting, fishing, hunting, and sailing were guided by constellations, with meanings varying by region and marking optimal times hunting and sailing.

the sun & moon as clocks

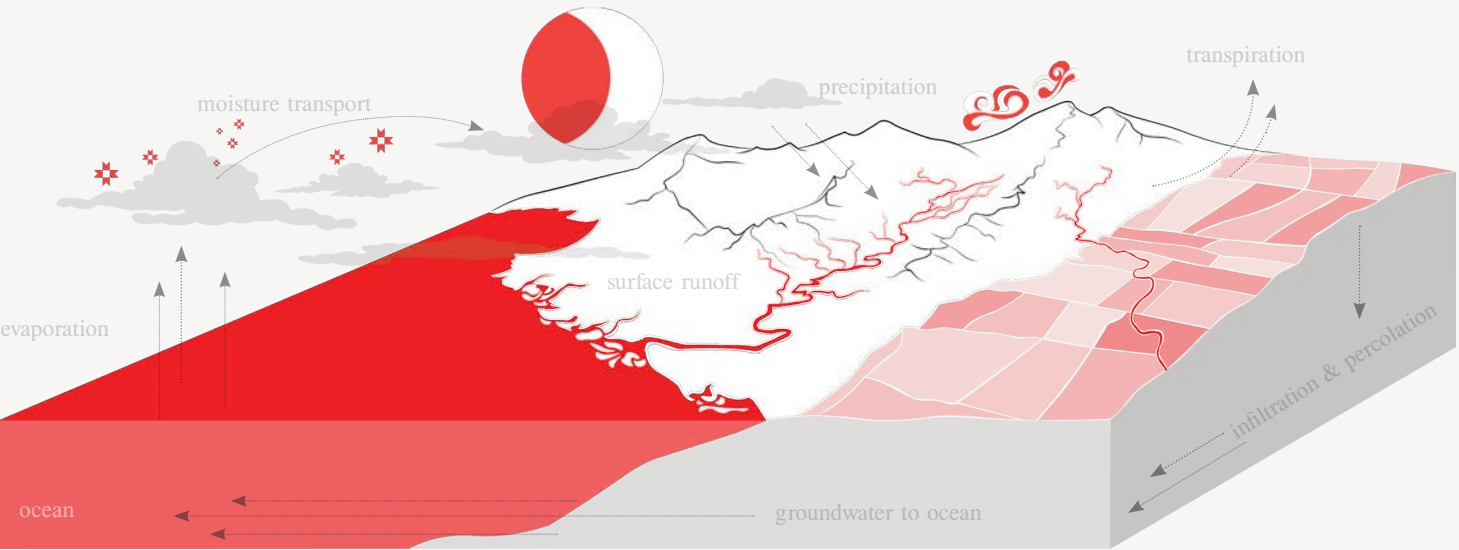
For early Filipinos, the sun and moon structured time. “Buan,” referred to the cycles of the moon, which guided agricultural cycles and marked transitions between periods.

the four elements

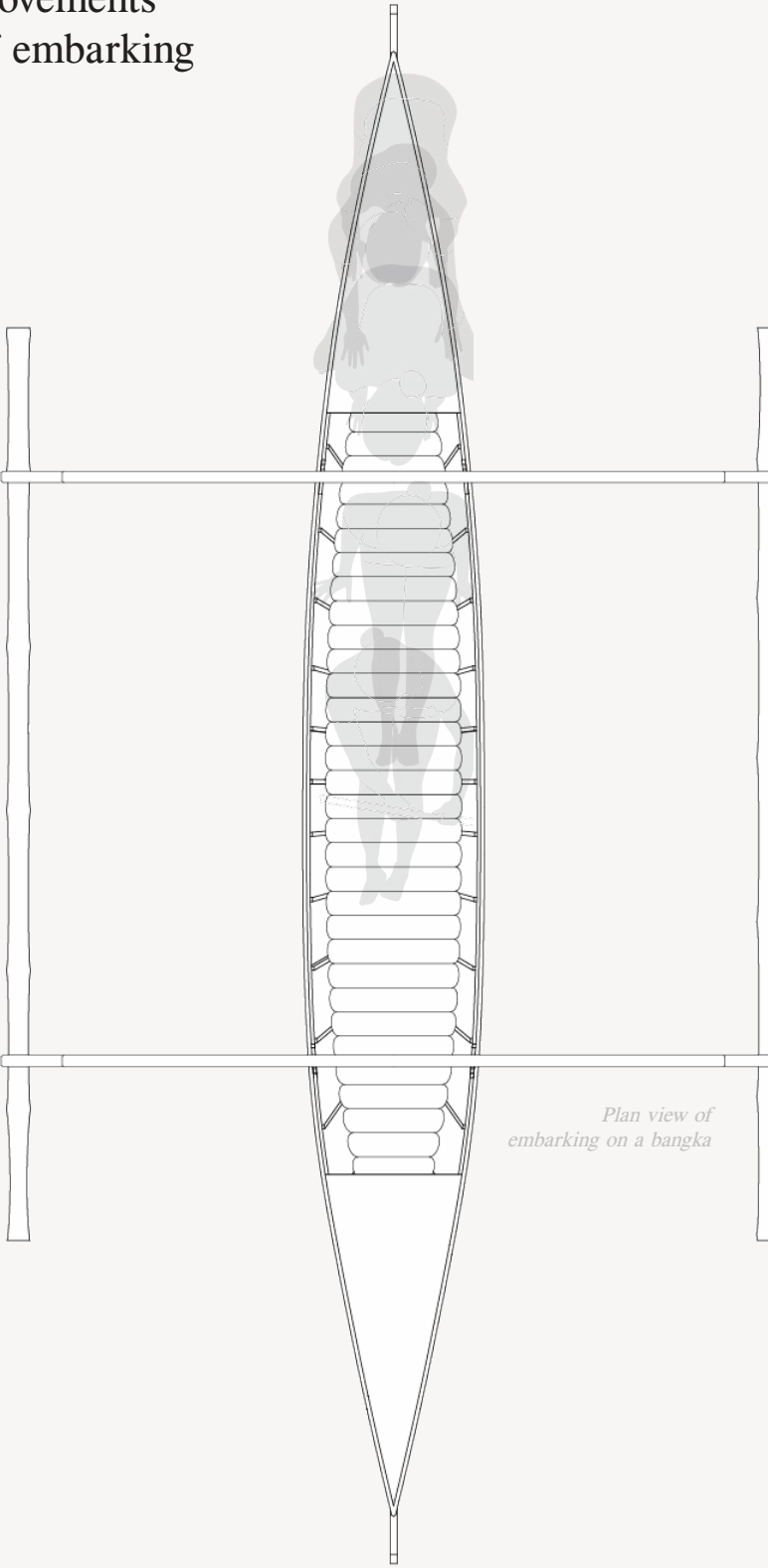
Early Filipinos worshipped diverse deities tied to specific realms, believed to have created the elements (air, water, fire, and earth), celestial bodies, and all life.

people as part of the cycle

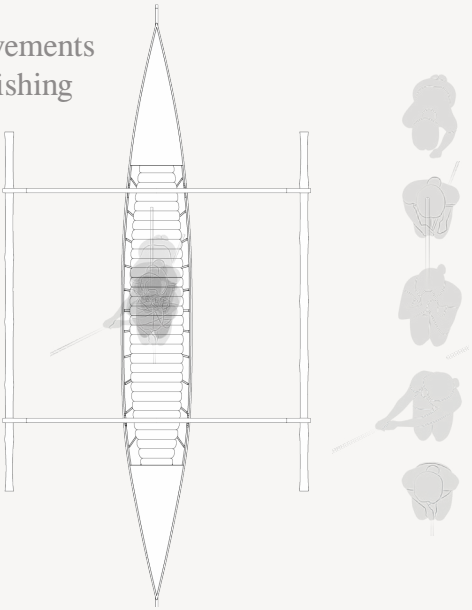
Filipinos maintain a sacred bond with the land as life-giving and central to identity, entrusted by the Creator for care and stewardship.



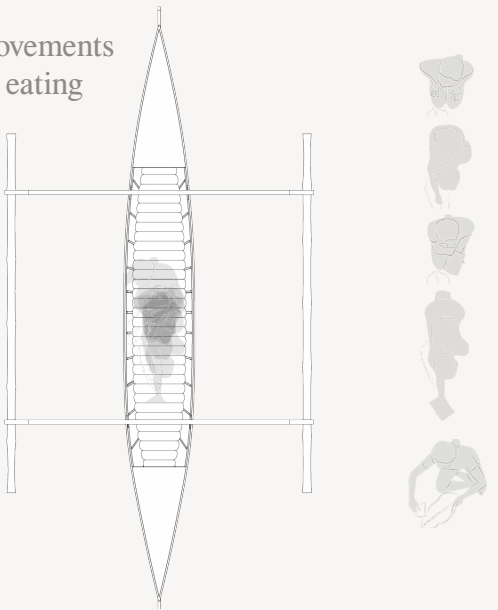
movements of embarking



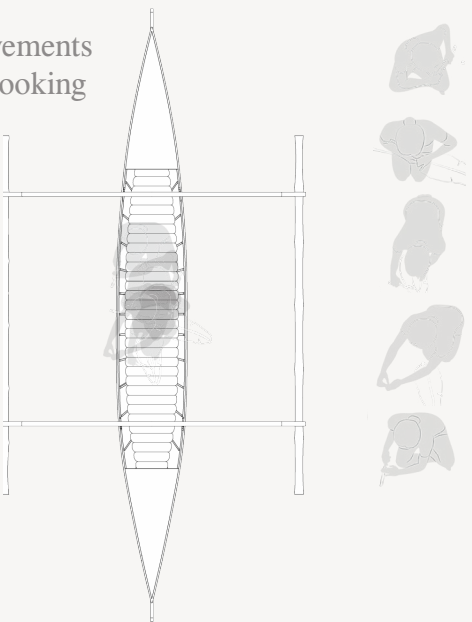
movements of fishing



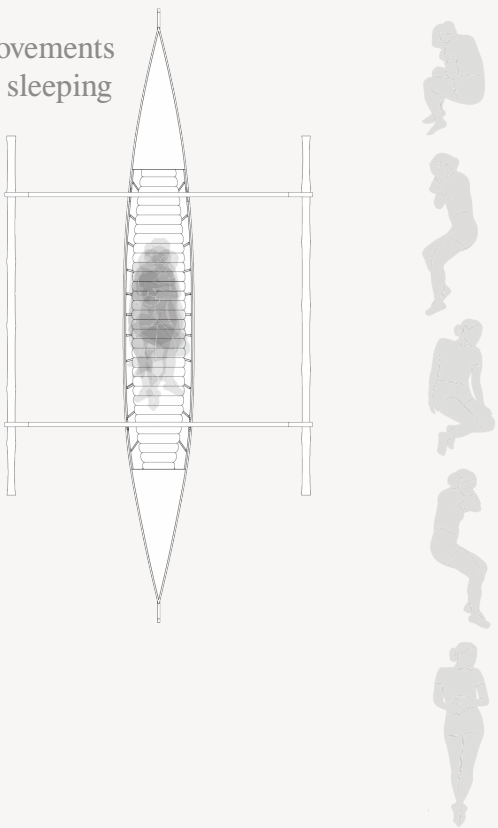
movements of eating



movements of cooking



movements of sleeping



movement methodologies

I completed sets of movements often performed on bangkas to better understand its architecture and form. These actions were daily activities that my grandparents and their three kids at the time performed. As a result of the space, these are not ordinary acts as the user enters a setting more harmonious, spiritual, and ceremonial. The drawings above diagram, describe, and document the learnings from the movements.

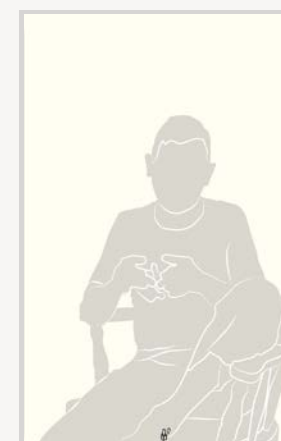
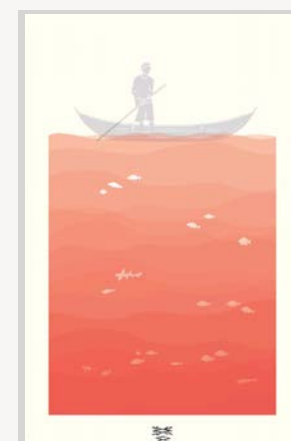
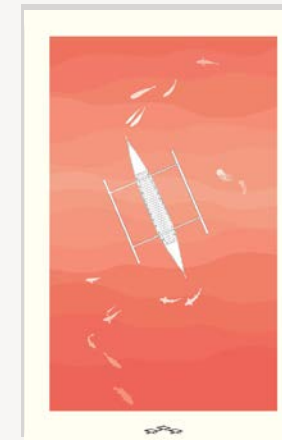
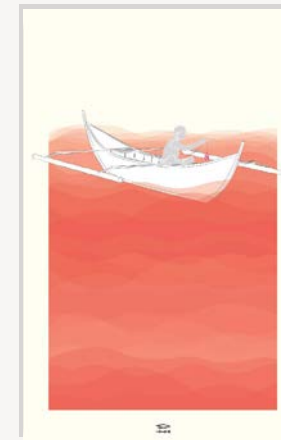
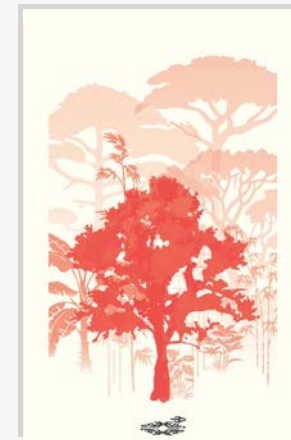
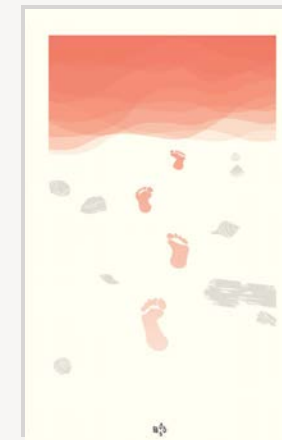
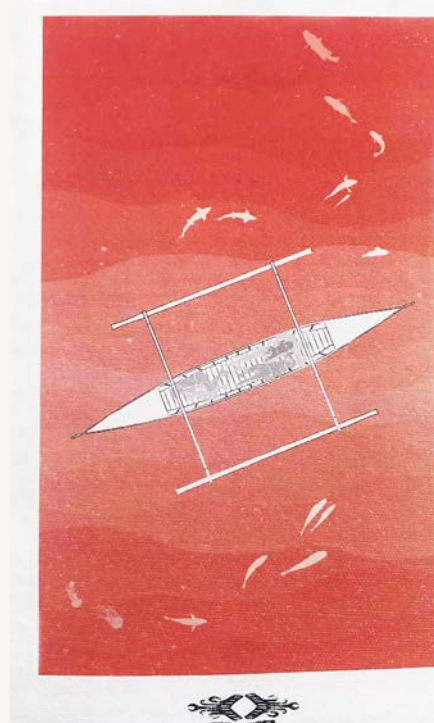


Para sa aking Lola Monica, Lolo Pablo, Virgilio, Romeo, at Maria. Maraming salamat sa lahat ng itinuro ninyo sa akin at sa lahat ng patuloy ninyong itinuturo.

the book

saling-tubig
[sa · ling - tu · big]
water as a vessel of knowledge
passed down through time

The book is dedicated to my Lola, Lolo, and their three kids at the time of the war. “Tubig,” translating to “water” in English, was one of the first words my parents taught me in Tagalog. This term was not just an introduction to the language, but an emphasis on the vital role of water as the source of life, nourishment, and sustenance.





mapping saysain

This map depicts my village of Saysain, located in Bagac, Bataan, Philippines, and its land and waters that sustain our people. The following prints are inspired by the form and process of traditional Filipino T’boli weaving.



mountain stream



palm tree



fallen vegetation



fallen leaf lolo



birds nest



fish seaweed crab



abaca tree



hanging vine stone work



farmer



sand shell hut



cloud snake alligator



banana root cerbera tree



water fishing navigating



jellyfish swordfish



almaciga tree



fire home



ardisia plant



bangkal tree



lola



bangka



Block printing and embroidery on textile
Dimensions: 54" x 78"

Photo by Daisy Wu



Photo by Daisy Wu

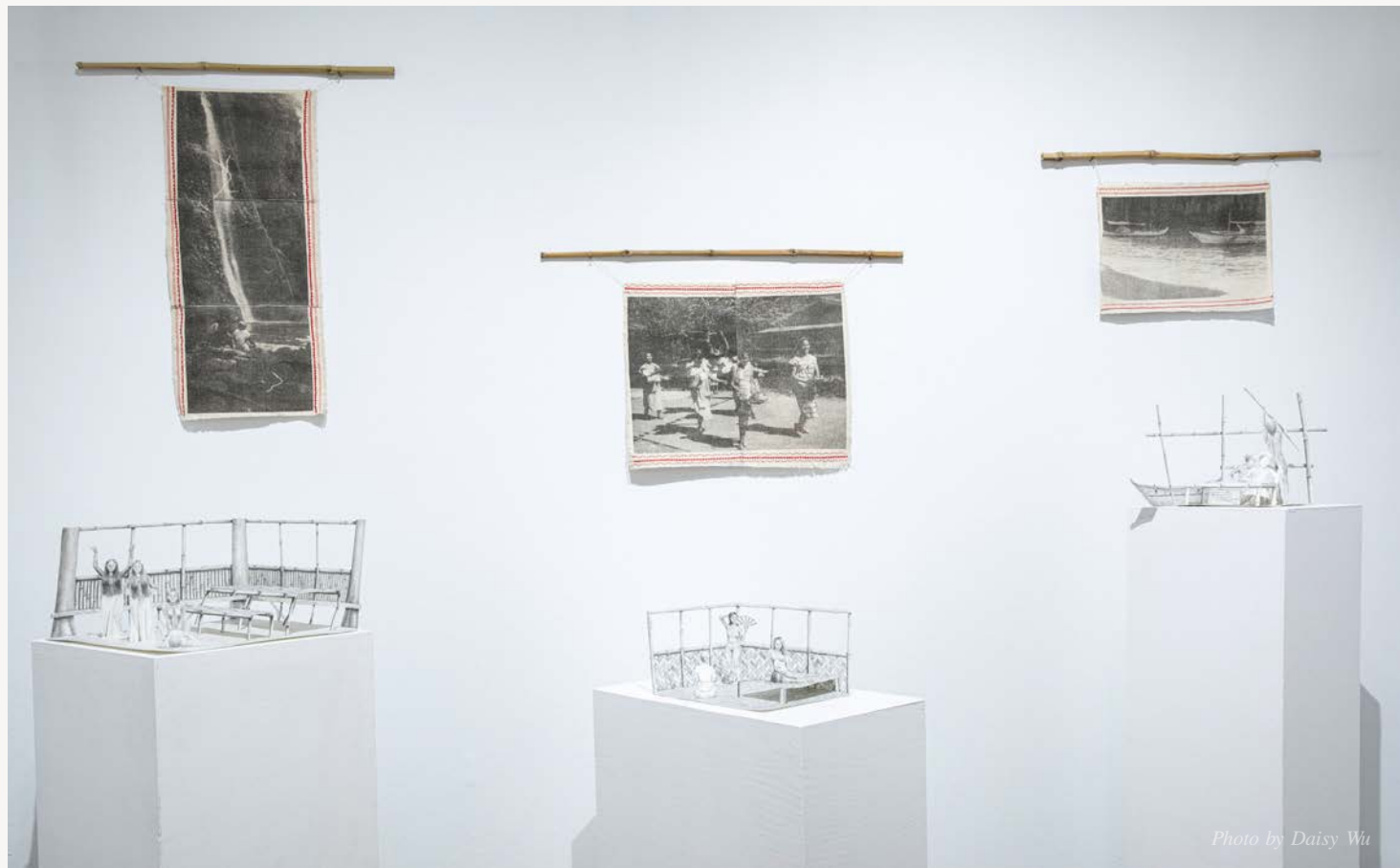


Photo by Daisy Wu



Photo by Daisy Wu

Embroidery and screen print on textile and bamboo dowels & charcoal vignettes on paper.

Inspired by the artist's personal family photo collection, ancestral practices that span from Mountain Mariveles to the Philippine Sea are reimagined through textile weaving and hand drawn vignettes. To envision a landscape inspired by pre-colonial histories and present-day traditions is an acknowledgement to the generations before us and an extension of gratitude to those who taught us.

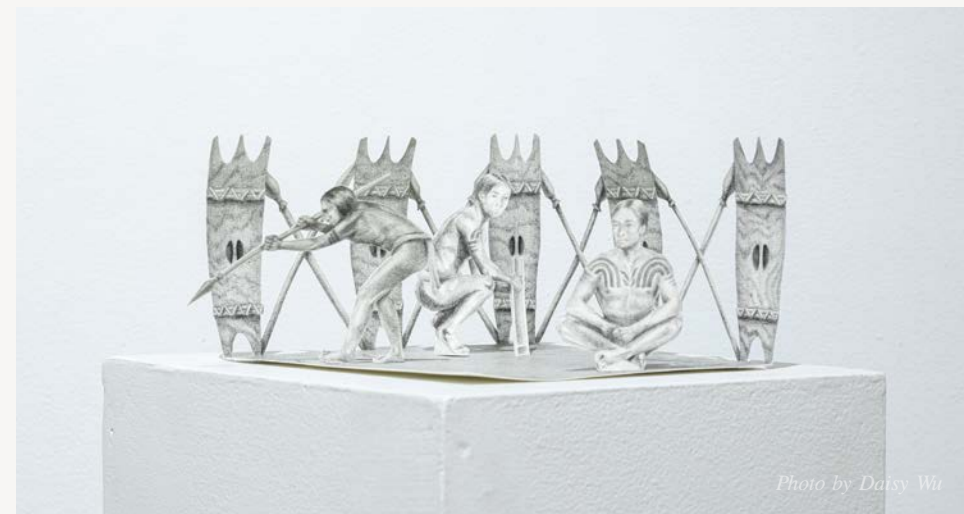


Photo by Daisy Wu

passages of the canals

Location: Venice, Italy

Year: 10.2025 - 11.2025

Dimensions: 12" x 14"

Material: woven cotton & wool

Fellowship: 2025 Venice Biennale



Photo by Del Ico

This tapestry depicts the canals of Venice as carriers of archive and memory, shaped by the artist's personal navigation and traditional understanding.

This piece will be featured in an upcoming issue of Site Magazine.



thank you
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